



MERIT EDUCATION GROUP

Combining Like Terms

I can combine like terms to simplify algebraic expressions.

Standard: 9.3.5.7

Day 10 · Unit 1 · Theme: Itasca State Park

1 BELL RINGER — WHITEBOARDS READY!

Combine: $3x + 5x$ — what do you notice?

Your response: _____

2 KEY VOCABULARY

Like Terms — Terms with the same variable raised to the same _____. _____

Combine — To add or subtract the _____ of like terms. _____

Simplify — To write an expression in its _____ equivalent form. _____

3 DIRECT INSTRUCTION — TAKE NOTES (I DO)

Example: Simplify $3x + 5 + 2x - 3$.

• Step 1 — Identify like terms: $3x$ and _____; 5 and _____. ($2x$, -3)

• Step 2 — Add the x-coefficients: $3 + 2 = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$. (5)

• Step 3 — Combine the constants: $5 - 3 = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$. (2)

• Step 4 — Simplified expression: $\underline{\hspace{2cm}}$. ($5x + 2$)

4 GUIDED PRACTICE — WORK TOGETHER (WE DO)

• Simplify $7a + 4 - 2a + 6$. Simplify $4y$ squared + $3y - 2y$ squared + y .

5 CULTURE CONNECTION — MINNESOTA STORIES

Liberian (Liberia) — Liberian Americans are a growing Minnesota community, many settling in Brooklyn Park and Brooklyn Center.

Word problem: A Liberian market sells rice in $4x$ -pound and $6x$ -pound bags. Simplify the total: $4x + 6x$.

Language fact: Dakota: 'Mni Sota Makoce' = 'land where the waters reflect the skies' — the origin of Minnesota's name

6**INDEPENDENT PRACTICE — YOU TRY!**

- Simplify $5m + 3n - 2m + 7n - 4$.
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7**EXIT TICKET — SHOW WHAT YOU KNOW**

Simplify: $4x + 7 - 2x + 3$.

Answer: _____

Show your work for full credit.